

Inference Skills

Name:

Date:

ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY05: Use comprehension strategies to build inferred meaning by drawing on context and prior knowledge.

Learning Intention: I am learning to use clues in the text and what I already know to work out things the author doesn't say directly.**Key Idea:** An **inference** is a smart guess. You use **clues from the text** plus **what you already know** to figure out something that isn't written directly.**Warm-Up:** Read: "Sam grabbed his umbrella and rain boots before leaving the house." What can you infer about the weather?

A. What Can You Infer?

Read each clue and write what you can infer.

1. Jack's stomach growled loudly during class.

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2. Lily's hands were covered in flour and sugar.

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B. Picture Clues

Imagine a picture of a dog with its tail between its legs and ears down. What can you infer about how the dog feels?

C. Clue Detective

Write two clues that would help someone infer that it is winter outside.

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D. True Inference or Not?

Circle YES if it is a good inference, NO if it is not.

1. "The ground was wet and there were puddles." → It probably rained. YES / NO

2. "The ground was wet." → The person's favourite colour is blue. YES / NO

Answer Guide & Extension Activities

Suggested Answers – A & B

- A.** 1. Jack is probably hungry. 2. Lily is probably baking.
- B.** The dog is probably scared or feeling sorry/ashamed.

Suggested Answers – C & D

- C.** Answers will vary – e.g. snow on the ground, people wearing coats and scarves.
- D.** 1. YES 2. NO

High Five Stars – Self Assessment

- ★ I used clues from the text ★ I used what I already know ★ I made smart guesses ★ I checked if my inference made sense

Extension Activity

Look around your room right now. Write one thing you can infer about someone who lives there, just from what you can see.

Parent/Teacher Tip

Everyday moments are great inference practice – ask 'What do you think happened here?' when you notice something unusual together.

Reflection

What is the difference between something you know for sure and something you infer?
